

Change orders

How to handle client changes in MillSuite — team guide · July 2026

The one idea: when a client changes anything after the job is sold, make a change order. It keeps the price, the paperwork, the shop specs, and QuickBooks in sync — automatically. No side deals, no sticky notes.

Where it lives

Open the project → open the subproject. The button sits at the top of the subproject page:

Main bar
Boyd — Anchor Bar Kissimmee · locked — sold

[+ Change order](#)

To see every change order across all jobs: **Sales → Change Orders**. Every CO also files its PDF in the project's **Documents** section.

One form, two modes

One button, one form. A toggle at the top switches how you describe the change:

Spec change

Custom

Spec change — it's already in the estimate
Door style, material, finish, drawers — anything the estimate already knows.

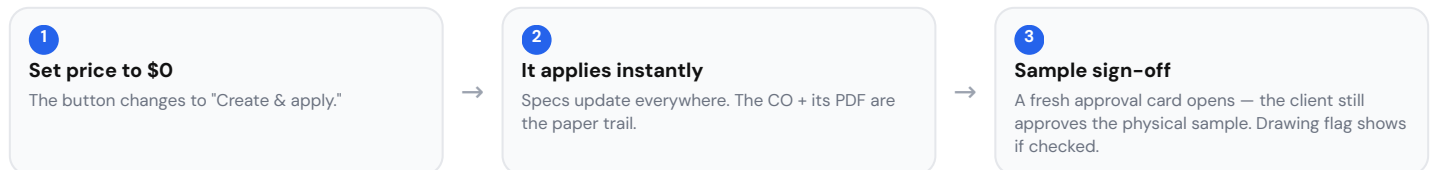
WHAT'S CHANGING?
Door type
Slab → Micro Shaker
Net change — priced automatically from the job's quantities
+\$649
The price math happens for you. Need a material we've never used? "+ Add new" saves it to the rate book for next time.

Custom — it's not in the estimate
Client-supplied item, vendor price change, one-off work.

MATERIALS
Brass rail — Vendor: Hardware Co 12 × \$48
LABOR — HOURS BY DEPARTMENT
ENG 1 · CNC 0 · ASM 3 · FIN 0 · INS 2
Client price — our margin built in, editable +\$1,552
Custom items never go into the rate book. Hours you enter here flow to the schedule once accepted.

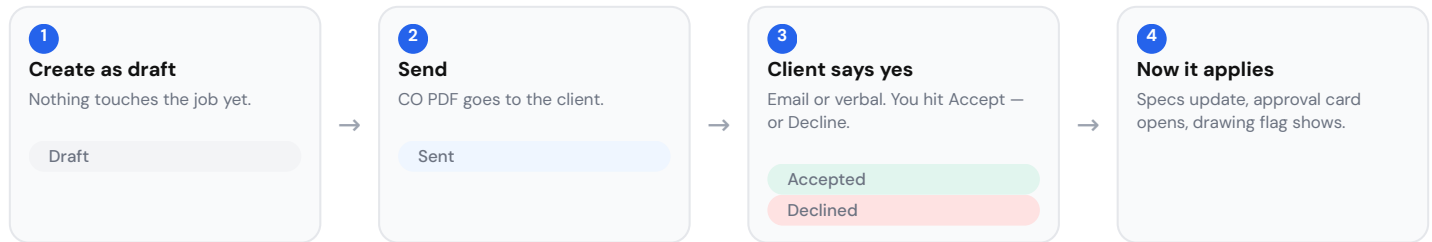
Free change — \$0, no charge

Only for true no-cost swaps (same-price paint color, hardware finish). **If it costs us more, we bill it.**



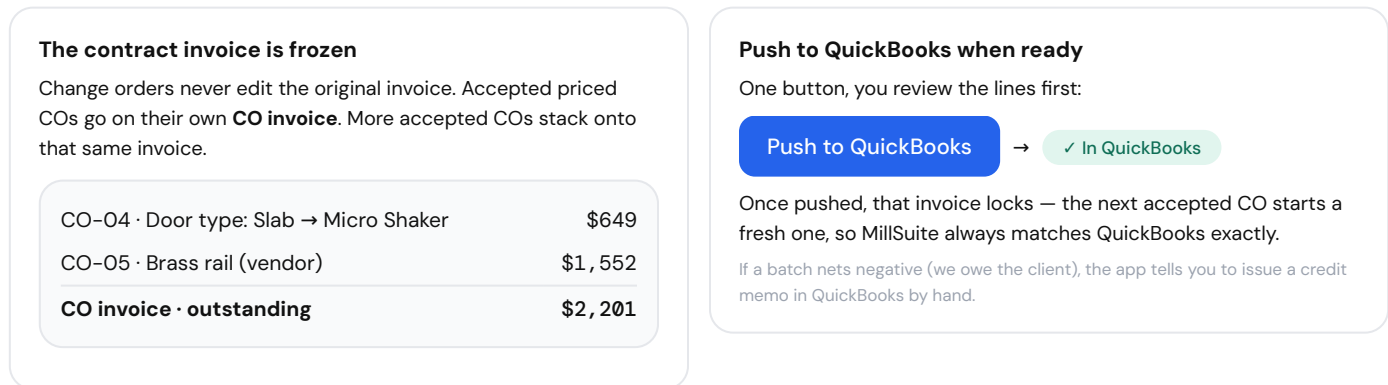
No invoice is created for a free change — nothing to bill.

Priced change — client pays



The rule that protects the shop: nothing about a priced change touches the job until you hit Accept. Nobody builds an unapproved change.

Billing — how the money flows



Reading the project money

Project price	\$53,144
Approved change orders	+\$2,201
Contract total	\$55,345

Rules of thumb

- **One change per CO.** New door AND new finish = two COs. They stack on one invoice, so it's painless.
- **Drawings don't update themselves.** The CO flags the revision — a person makes it.
- **Price approval ≠ sample approval.** Accepting the money side re-opens the finish card; the client still signs off on the physical sample.
- **A CO on a job already in production shows a big red warning.** Rare, and a big deal — talk it through before accepting.
- **Everything files itself.** CO PDFs, invoices, and links live in the project's Documents section.